

ALP / Contractor Circle

Owner Dependency Scorecard

How reliant is your business on you?

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Why This Matters

Every contractor starts as the person who does everything. You sell the work, estimate the work, manage the work, pay the bills, and handle the problems. That is how you survive in the early years.

But what got you here will not get you to the next level. If your business cannot function without you for 30 days, you do not own a company — you own a job. A job that does not scale, cannot be sold, and will burn you out.

This scorecard gives you an honest, measurable picture of where you stand today. It identifies exactly where you are the bottleneck and where to focus your energy to build a business that runs without you.

How to Use This Scorecard

Rate your company on a scale of **1 to 5** in each of the five categories below. Read the descriptions carefully and circle the number that most honestly reflects your current reality — not where you want to be, but where you actually are today.

Score	Meaning
1	Total Dependency — You do this entirely yourself. It fails without you.
2	High Dependency — You have some help, but you are still the bottleneck.
3	Moderate Dependency — A team or process exists, but you still step in frequently.
4	Low Dependency — It runs without you 80-90% of the time.
5	Zero Dependency — Fully delegated to a capable leader with a documented process.

Category 1: Vision & Leadership

Can the company set goals, resolve conflicts, and stay aligned without you driving it every day?

Score	What It Looks Like
1	You are the only one setting goals. You constantly push everyone to get things done. Without your energy, nothing moves.
2	You have a leadership team, but they rely on you to solve their disputes and make the final call on everything.
3	You hold regular leadership meetings, but you still drive most of the agenda and hold people accountable yourself.
4	Your leadership team functions well independently. You mostly provide strategic guidance.
5	You have a strong Integrator who runs the day-to-day business, resolves issues, and executes the vision without you.

Your Score: _____

Category 2: Sales & Estimating

Can the company generate leads, build relationships, estimate projects, and close deals without you?

Score	What It Looks Like
1	You are the only rainmaker. If you stop selling, the pipeline dries up. You estimate every job yourself.
2	You have estimators, but you review and approve every bid. You still close all the major deals personally.
3	You have a sales team, but they rely heavily on your relationships and your final sign-off on pricing.
4	The sales and estimating team consistently hits targets with minimal input from you.
5	You are completely removed from sales and estimating. The team generates leads, estimates accurately, and closes deals on their own.

Your Score: _____

Category 3: Operations & Field Production

Can projects be managed, crews scheduled, quality maintained, and problems solved without you?

Score	What It Looks Like
1	You are essentially the lead PM or Super. You schedule crews, order materials, and put out fires every day.
2	You have PMs or Supers, but they constantly call you for answers, approvals, and problem-solving.
3	Operations run decently, but you still step in when things go wrong or clients escalate.
4	Your operations team handles almost all field issues and project delivery independently.
5	Operations are fully systematized. Projects are delivered on time, on budget, and to quality standards without your involvement.

Your Score: _____

Category 4: Finance & Cash Flow

Can the company manage cash flow, collect receivables, pay bills, and report profitability without you?

Score	What It Looks Like
1	You handle the books, pay the bills, and chase down clients for money yourself.
2	You have a bookkeeper, but you still manage cash flow daily and approve every expense.
3	Financial processes exist, but you still spend significant time reviewing numbers and managing AR/AP.
4	Your finance team provides accurate, timely reports. You only review high-level metrics.
5	You have a strong finance leader who manages all financial operations, cash flow, and reporting completely independently.

Your Score: _____

Category 5: People & Culture

Can the company recruit, hire, train, hold accountable, and fire without you making every decision?

Score	What It Looks Like
1	You do all the interviewing, hiring, and firing. You are the sole judge of who fits and who goes.
2	Managers help with hiring, but you still make the final decision on every candidate and every termination.
3	You have a hiring process, but you still get pulled into employee disputes and training issues regularly.
4	Managers handle their own hiring and firing based on your core values, with minimal input from you.
5	The company has a self-sustaining culture. Your leadership team recruits, hires, trains, and retains top talent without you.

Your Score: _____

Your Total Score

Add up your five category scores below.

Category	Score
1. Vision & Leadership	_____
2. Sales & Estimating	_____
3. Operations & Field Production	_____
4. Finance & Cash Flow	_____
5. People & Culture	_____
TOTAL	_____ / 25

What Your Score Tells You

5 – 10: The Owner’s Trap

Your business is entirely dependent on you. You are working long hours, putting out fires, and acting as the bottleneck for every major decision. If you step away for two weeks, things fall apart. You do not have a business — you have a high-stress, self-created job.

Your priority: Start documenting your core processes and identify the first seat on your Accountability Chart that you need to fill with a capable leader.

11 – 17: The Transition Phase

You have started building a team and implementing systems, but you are still too involved in the details. You struggle to let go of control because “nobody does it as well as you.” Growth is limited by your personal capacity.

Your priority: Identify the specific decisions you are still making that your team should be making. Empower your leaders to own their seats fully. Stop being the safety net.

18 – 22: The Scalable Business

You have built a strong leadership team and solid processes. The business operates and grows without your constant presence. You are functioning primarily as a Visionary — setting direction, building relationships, and thinking strategically.

Your priority: Optimize your systems, coach your leadership team to the next level, and begin exploring new strategic growth opportunities.

23 – 25: The Autonomous Enterprise

Your business is a fully mature, self-sustaining asset. It operates completely independently of you. You have achieved true owner freedom — the ability to step away, pursue other ventures, or prepare for a highly profitable exit.

Your priority: Focus on long-term wealth building, acquisitions, or positioning the business for sale at maximum valuation.

Your Action Plan

Based on your scores, answer the following three questions:

1. What is your lowest-scoring category?

2. Who on your team should be accountable for that function? (Refer to your Accountability Chart.)

3. What is the ONE thing you can delegate or systematize in the next 90 days to raise that score by at least one point? (Make this a Quarterly Rock.)

“The goal is not to work harder. The goal is to build a machine that works without you.”

— Marshall Wilkinson
